

Intelligence Report

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Executive Summary

Deepfake and AI-generated disinformation targeting Sabarimala pilgrims are being spread through Telegram channels in Malayalam and Hindi, using coordinated bot networks and WhatsApp to amplify content. This has occurred since the season of 2019, with specific campaigns noted during Mandalam 2026. Kerala Cyber Safety Protocol may apply due to the synthetic nature of images. Disinformation includes fake photos depicting violence and police inaction that are misleadingly shared by channels like @sabarimala_truth_ml and @sabarimala_truth_hindi.

Key Findings

- Deepfake and AI-generated disinformation targeting Sabarimala pilgrims on Telegram
- Coordinated bot networks and WhatsApp amplify content during peak pilgrim traffic
- Specific campaigns occurred during Mandalam 2026 season
- One photo had deepfaked face with clear synthetic skin texture around jawline
- Viral photos about violence at Pamba look suspicious, one from an indoor event location

Recommendations

- Monitoring and takedown of disinformation on Telegram and WhatsApp
- Implementing measures under the Kerala Cyber Safety Protocol for reporting and handling of synthetic media
- Raising awareness among pilgrims about detecting fake photos and misinformation

Source Citations

- <https://reddit.com/r/IndianMediaAnalysis/comments/def012>
- <https://reddit.com/r/india/comments/abc789>
- <https://reddit.com/r/Kerala/comments/yza456>
- <https://reddit.com/r/Kerala/comments/ghi345>
- https://t.me/sabarimala_truth_hindi/302
- <https://truthofkerala.blogspot.com/2026/sabarimala-violence>